cost us a Test match and series victory. If Rahul was so keen to show intent here in Multan, he should have done the same in Sydney.

Rahul didn't say anything to this and stated that I would surely get another opportunity to score a double hundred. I disagreed, saying it would not be the same. I would have to bat from zero to score a double century and would not be starting my innings at 194. Before I brought the conversation to a close, I assured Rahul that the incident would have no bearing on my involvement on the field, but off the field I would prefer to be left alone for a while to come to terms with what had happened.

Despite this incident, I am glad to say Rahul and I remain good friends, and even on the field our camaraderie remained intact until the end of our careers. We continued to have some good partnerships and neither our cricket nor our friendship was affected.

Learning from history

A very similar situation arose a few years later, in December 2008, when we were playing England at Mohali. It was the last day of the Test match and Gautam Gambhir and Yuvraj were both in the seventies. Yet again there was talk of a possible declaration in the dressing room. It was being argued that we needed to declare immediately and put the English in for some thirty overs so that we could try and force a win.

I intervened and stopped the declaration. Dhoni was our captain then and Gary Kirsten our coach. I said that I had been in this situation before and did not want a repeat of what had happened to me. There was no way we could win the game by putting the English in after lunch. There was not enough time – particularly because on each day so far, play had finished early because the light in Mohali did not last long and the last day was expected to be no different. In such a situation, what was the point of declaring and depriving the two batsmen of the chance to get their hundreds? Gautam had already scored one in the first innings, so he had a rare opportunity to make a hundred in each innings. Yuvraj, on the other hand, had played a key role in winning us the first Test at Chennai and it was only fair to give him the chance of a Test hundred.

Finally, I said it was our responsibility to look after the interests of all individuals who were part of the team, because a bunch of happy individuals make a happy team. I wasn't suggesting that we should place